



▲ TOKAREV SVT40

Date 1940

Origin Soviet Union

Barrel 24in (61cm)

Caliber 7.62 × 54mm

Fedor Tokarev designed a self-loading rifle with a tilting bolt locking into the floor of the receiver, and had it accepted by the Red Army in 1938. Two years later, he produced a more robust weapon that was cheaper and quicker to manufacture. The Samozaryadnaya Vintovka Tokarev 40 (SVT40) was issued to noncommissioned officers, and some were employed as sniper rifles.



▲ M1 CARBINE

Date 1941

Origin US

Barrel 18in (46cm)

Caliber .30in

Designed to be lighter and handier than an infantry rifle, and employing cartridges more powerful than those used by pistols, the M1 was intended as an alternative to the rifle and the pistol. Issued from 1942, it was chambered for an intermediate round developed by Winchester, and had an action similar to that of the Garand (top), except it had a short-stroke gas piston. It was also produced with a folding butt (see pp.214–15).

▲ GEWEHR 43

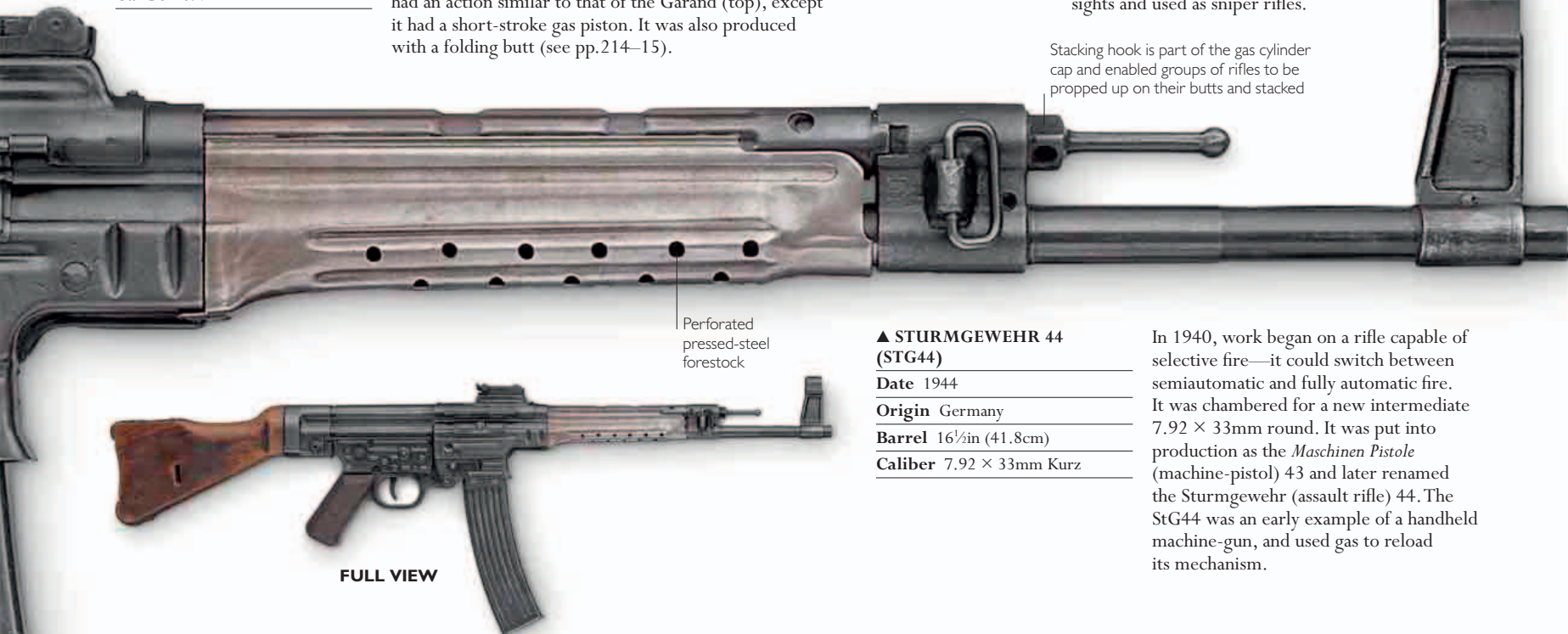
Date 1943

Origin Germany

Barrel 22in (56cm)

Caliber 7.92 × 57mm

The German army's request for a self-loading rifle to increase infantry firepower spurred the introduction of the successful Gewehr rifle 43. A number of them were fitted with telescopic sights and used as sniper rifles.



▲ STURMGEWehr 44 (STG44)

Date 1944

Origin Germany

Barrel 16½in (41.8cm)

Caliber 7.92 × 33mm Kurz

In 1940, work began on a rifle capable of selective fire—it could switch between semiautomatic and fully automatic fire. It was chambered for a new intermediate 7.92 × 33mm round. It was put into production as the *Maschinen Pistole* (machine-pistol) 43 and later renamed the Sturmgewehr (assault rifle) 44. The StG44 was an early example of a handheld machine-gun, and used gas to reload its mechanism.

FULL VIEW